

Make music with Reaper

Create and edit the next club banger track right at your home!

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Reaper is a very flexible and versatile audio production software. Developed by Cockos Incorporated, REAPER is an audio editing platform like no other. Despite being a lightweight program, it can literally do it all. You name an audio editing task and REAPER will be there with an inbuilt tool or a plugin that will help you accomplish it in a breeze.

Want to record, process and export 64-bit audio right from your system? REAPER can do it. Want to connect a MIDI device to your computer and produce professional grade soundtracks without much hassle? REAPER is the answer. A digital audio workstation that is available for a fraction of the cost than some of the other similar applications in the market, REAPER is not the be all and end all, for a beginner or an intermediate but is definitely a good starting point for most.

SETUP

Setting up REAPER is simple on all the platforms be it Windows, MacOS or Linux. Since it is not available on the app stores of either Windows or

MacOS, you will have to sideload it on to your machine from the official website. For MacOS users, there are certain specific instructions depending upon the hardware and software that you are running so we would recommend going through those before you download the install file. This guide

will focus on running REAPER on MacOS. The process is almost identical for almost every operating system.

After you have downloaded the REAPER install file, and are through the initial setup, where depending upon your operating system, certain permissions may or may not be needed, you will be greeted with the screen to select the preferred audio devices. For most users, the default settings would do just fine, but for the ones rocking dedicated audio input and output devices, this setup will be necessary. Once you click on the 'Yes' button when prompted to do so, after the first install, you will be taken to a menu where there will be a myriad of customization options waiting for you. In that menu, the dropdown labelled 'Audio Device' is what you will have to click to get a list of audio devices connected to your system. Identify the relevant device if any, else let it remain on default settings. The devices can also be configured after installation.

GET THAT PARTY STARTED

One of the most used equipment of music producers or anyone who is trying to make a new track from scratch are the MIDI devices. Musical Instrument Digital Interface (MIDI) is the interface that lets you connect a supported musical instrument say a DJ

controller to your computer. To set it up, you will have to navigate to the menu option located on the top bar of your application, showing the details of your current project such as the sampling rate, latency, etc. There, select the 'Audio device settings' option. The menu that

opens will have, under the Audio category, an option called as MIDI Devices. Click that and you will be greeted with the list of MIDI devices connected to your computer system. From there, identify your MIDI device and double click on it, to open another menu that will have the option alongside a check box, which would read 'Enable input from this device'. That's it, you will start getting input from that 1980's digital keyboard that you have been hanging on to, for years now.

With the setup out of the way, you will need a track to record the inputs from your device. To create a new track, head over to the top menu bar again, and find the 'Track' option. From the drop down, select 'Insert New



Audio devices settings menu



The settings menu showing all the MIDI devices hooked up to the system